

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 4 2
 ♥ J 10 9 6 3
 ♦ 8 6 4
 ♣ J 6

♠ A K Q 5

♥ 7 5

♦ 10 7 2

♣ A 10 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 8 6

♥ A 8 4 2

♦ 5

♣ K 9 4 2

♠ 9 3

♥ K Q

♦ A K Q J 9 3

♣ Q 8 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♥	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by South
 at trick 3.

Then start running the ♦ suit.

This is the situation after you have unblocked dummy's ♣A and then played 5 ♦ winners.

So far neither defender is hurting, but that is about to change.

You play your ♦3 and discard dummy's ♣10.

East is squeezed. He can't throw his ♣K without letting your ♣Q become a winner. But if he discards a ♠ dummy's ♠5 will win the last trick. This is soooo much fun.

South is to play 6NT. West leads the ♥J. East wins the ♥A and returns the ♥2.

With only 11 winners you need to find one more and your prospects are quite slim.

No matter how the ♠s split only one defender will hold the Guard because only one defender can have as many as 4. IF (it's a big IF) that same defender holds the ♣K then you can squeeze him.

Can you see how the squeeze is going to work?

If you try to run your ♦s right away you will have a problem with your ♣Q later on. It will be no good as a Threat card because you will have no entry back to your hand.

The solution is the Vienna Coup. Play a ♣ to the ♣A

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 6 4

♥ 10

♦ 10 9 7 4 2

♣ 8 2

♠ 9 3

♥ K 9 8 6 3

♦ A 6

♣ A K Q 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 8 5 2

♥ 4

♦ K Q 8 3

♣ J 10 9 3

♠ K 7

♥ A Q J 7 5 2

♦ J 5

♣ 7 6 4

West	North	East	South
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Pass

3♣

Pass

1♥

Pass

6♥

3♥

All Pass

6♥ by South
squeeze him.

Play 5♥ winners and the ♠K.

Drum roll please.

Play your ♥2 and dump dummy's ♦6.

East has no answer.

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♠Q. East wins the ♠A and plays the ♦K.

Of course you have noticed that in most of these hands you are exactly one trick short. No coincidence - it's when you are one trick short and can't find another likely plan that you start to look for a squeeze.

In this hand dummy's fourth ♣ is an obvious Threat, so you should ask yourself if you can find another Threat for when ♣s don't split 3-3. Another thing you have probably noticed is that although 3-3 splits happen about 40% of the time in real life, they **NEVER** happen in these pages!

East's ♦K play helps you find the other Threat. It appears that he must hold the ♦Q also, so your ♦J is now a Threat against East. If he holds 4 ♣s you can

Board 5

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 8
♥ K Q 10 7 5
♦ 10 8 4
♣ J 9 5 2

♠ A 5 2
♥ J 6
♦ A K J 7 5 3
♣ K 7

N
W E
S

♠ J 10 9 6 4
♥ 9 8 3 2
♦ -
♣ Q 10 6 3

♠ K Q 7 3
♥ A 4
♦ Q 9 6 2
♣ A 8 4

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	4♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			
7NT by South			